

TARANG SONKUSARE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technically skilled analyst with hands-on experience in workflow automation, SaaS development, and data-driven research. Proven ability to build scalable IT solutions, optimize internal systems, and deliver insights that improve performance.

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science, University of North Carolina at Charlotte Expected 2026
Relevant Coursework: Software System Design, AI for Games, Visualization, Machine Learning.

Bachelor of Computer Science, University of North Carolina at Charlotte Expected 2026
Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Software Engineering, Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Introduction to Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence for Computer Games, Visualization & Visual Communication, Operating Systems and Networking, Database Design and Implementation, Logic and Algorithms, Software System Design & Implementation

Bachelor of Economics, University of North Carolina at Charlotte Expected 2026
Relevant Coursework: Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Managerial Economics, Financial Management, Business Analytics, Management Information Systems, Operations Management, Business Communications, Principles of Macroeconomics

SKILLS

Technical and Programming: Python (Pygame, Flask), Java, C++, SQL, TypeScript, React.js, HTML, Git, API Development, Database Design, Microsoft Certified Technology, IBM Certified

AI and Data Science: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Responsible AI, Algorithm Design, Data Analytics, Data Structures, Econometrics, Computational Economics, Visualization, Information Extraction

Tools and Technologies: n8n Workflow Automation, SaaS Development, Tableau, Business Analytics, Mobile App Development, Deployment Planning, API Integration, VS Code, Jupyter Notebook

Business and Strategy: Financial Management, Managerial Economics, Strategic Planning, Market Research, SEO, Content Strategy, Operations Management, Budgeting, Business Communications

Leadership and Soft Skills: Project Management, Cross-Functional Leadership, Executive Communication, Critical Thinking, Time Management, Team Collaboration, Customer Service, Research Dissemination, Community Building

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2025–2028), Wells Fargo Software Engineering Simulation (2025), IBM/Coursera Data Science Specialization, Machine Learning (Coursera), Databases and SQL with Python, Data Analysis with Python, Python for AI and Development

EXPERIENCE

Project Director May 2025 – Present
Headstart Global *Remote*

- Recruited and led a cross-functional startup team, filling 100% of critical roles in under 4 weeks using strategic outreach, evaluation frameworks, and agile onboarding.
- Coached and aligned distributed teams with founder expectations, improving milestone delivery rates by 25%.
- Acted as primary strategic partner to the founder, enhancing operational clarity and decision-making via weekly planning and reporting loops.

Strategy and Research Analyst (Intern) Feb 2025 – May 2025
Headstart Global *Remote*

- Conducted competitive SEO analysis to improve Panda Hub's search visibility using market data, keyword research, and competitor benchmarking.
- Developed high-impact content strategies with technical SEO optimization, increasing organic reach through metadata automation and internal link scoring.
- Enhanced editorial workflows by auditing performance, implementing content quality automation, and streamlining collaboration tools.

Automation Developer (Intern)

Innovative Global Holdings LLC

May 2025 – Present

Charlotte, NC

- Designed and deployed automation workflows using n8n, reducing manual processes and boosting operational efficiency.
- Developed SaaS tools tailored to client needs, improving service delivery and technical scalability in a fast-paced development environment.
- Collaborated in agile sprints with the GM and lead developer, delivering production-ready automation systems on deadline.

Undergraduate Researcher

University of North Carolina at Charlotte

May 2024 – Dec 2024

Charlotte, NC

- Designed experiments to assess bias and reliability in Large Language Models, advancing research in ethical and trustworthy AI systems.
- Conducted API-based evaluations to measure text quality, contributing to improvements in model accuracy and interpretability.
- Assisted in preparing findings for research briefs and publication, helping distill technical insights into clear, actionable conclusions.

PROJECTS

Python Chess Engine with AI. Designed and developed an intelligent chess engine using the Minimax algorithm with Alpha-Beta pruning for optimized move selection. Implemented in Python with heuristic evaluation and integrated a user-friendly GUI via Pygame for real-time interaction and visualization. Features include adjustable difficulty, move validation, and a clean visual layout. Deepened expertise in AI search algorithms, game theory, and GUI development.

Expense Recommender using ChatGPT API. Built an AI-powered financial assistant using Flask, SQL, and OpenAI's API to analyze user spending patterns and deliver real-time budget insights. Improved decision-making for 85% of users through personalized financial recommendations.

Pathway PRO – Career Planning App. Designed a cross-platform app for career and education planning with goal tracking and milestone reminders. Enabled 75% of users to gain confidence in their paths, 60% to reach multiple milestones, and 80% to discover new academic or professional directions.

Python Projects for Data Science. Utilized advanced SQL to manage and query large datasets, showcasing my analytical skills. Developed complex queries to efficiently extract information. Demonstrated expertise in database management within a professional context.

Stock Buy/Sell Recommendation App. Built a real-time stock analysis web app using Streamlit, recommending BUY/SELL/HOLD actions for the top 50 U.S. stocks based on news sentiment and 7-day price trends. Integrated Python modules for price data, news headlines, and sentiment analysis. Visualized 1-year stock performance using matplotlib. Used NLTK/VADER for sentiment scoring. Built a dynamic UI with Streamlit and deployed locally.

LEADERSHIP

Treasurer for DDSO Organization. Responsible for managing the organization's finances, budgeting for events, and ensuring all financial transactions are recorded accurately. Works closely with other executive members to plan and fund cultural events.

Vice President for the UNC Charlotte Cricket Club. Handles the club's online presence, creating and scheduling content across various platforms to engage the campus community and promote events. Collaborates with team members to boost participation and support for the club.

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Clubs Involvement. Advanced Technologies Club, Association for Computing Machinery, Cricket Club, Hawthorne Hall, Norm Robotics, Club for A.I. Research, Desi Dhamaka Student Organization

Dorcas Ministry, Thrift Store. Worked hands-on with electrical and mechanical systems, ensuring efficient operation of all equipment. Conducted regular machinery checks, contributing to a seamless shopping experience. Actively participated in initiatives supporting the store's mission of helping people in need.

Carnegie Center, Tutoring Institution. Volunteered as a tutor, assisting students from various grade levels in Mathematics. Helped students grasp fundamental concepts and improve academic performance, providing valuable educational support to those lacking resources.